

Edmar Barros

Staff Software Engineer

Brazil

✉ hello[@]edmarbarros[.]com

🌐 edmarbarros.com

Staff Software Engineer with 10+ years building and operating production-grade distributed systems, most recently building AI-driven growth tooling at Quander (Hypesonic). I tie engineering work to business outcomes: opened a self-serve revenue stream with Stripe subscriptions, improved an unbalanced Elasticsearch cluster to cut its cost by 41%, halved new-engineer ramp-up time and reduced customer onboarding from 2 weeks to 1 day. Specialized in backend architecture (monolith-to-microservices), cloud infrastructure (GCP, AWS, Terraform, Kubernetes), CI/CD and data platforms (PostgreSQL, Kafka, Elasticsearch, BigQuery).

"The mind that opens to a new idea never returns to its original size." - Albert Einstein

Experience

Vocational

May 2026 - **Senior Software Engineer, Quander (Accel)**, Remote.

Oct 2026 Maker of Hypesonic, an AI growth platform that runs marketing and distribution continuously: testing creative, targeting audiences and optimizing ad spend without human bottlenecks.

Achievements:

- **Observable agent that keeps its context:** Added Langfuse tracing and prompt management for the in-product Sonic agent, and made its sessions recover after a reboot and rehydrate on cold start.
- **Tools and a sourcing agent:** Gave the agent tools for Meta performance data and live TikTok ad search, and built a background agent that fills a global ad library, with media analyzed by Gemini.
- **LLM-written reports:** Built LLM narration for the weekly performance report, with a provider abstraction and a validator.
- **Self-serve revenue:** Built Stripe subscriptions, a paywall and credit top-ups, with agent token use priced and debited atomically. Before this, B2B customers were billed manually.
- **Meta sync and ad publishing:** Rebuilt the Meta ad sync around a per-ad model that cut API cost about 25x, and built the Meta Ad Launcher for batch publishing, plus the TikTok connection and ad sync.
- **Observability and video:** Built a shared logger, an OpenTelemetry bootstrap and a shared PostHog package, and the video editor engine with Whisper transcription.
- **Closing the loop with users:** Joined beta tester calls and onboarding walkthroughs to see where users struggled, and joined twice-weekly calls with an agency using the platform, turning its feedback into fixes and features.

Key Technologies: TypeScript, Node.js, Next.js, LLM APIs & AI agents, LangGraph, Langfuse, OpenTelemetry, PostgreSQL, BullMQ, Docker, Stripe, Meta Marketing API, TikTok Ads API, PostHog

May 2024 - **Staff Software Engineer & Solutions Architect, Vendoo (YC W22)**, Remote.

May 2026 Multichannel listing tool and inventory management software for online sellers, processing 90k+ daily listings across distributed services.

Achievements:

- **Cut Elasticsearch spend by 41%:** Rebuilt an unbalanced Elasticsearch cluster (oversized shards, outdated version, no index lifecycle policies) and documented a roadmap for further savings.
- **Scaled to 90k+ daily listings:** Led the migration from a Node.js monolith to event-driven microservices on Kafka, reducing listing latency by 300ms and cutting failed marketplace syncs.
- **Halved new-engineer ramp-up (6 to 3 weeks):** Launched internal Tech Talks (10+ sessions) and a structured 1:1 mentorship framework.
- **Faster, lighter releases:** Re-engineered build and deployment pipelines, shrinking Docker images by 70% (1GB to 300MB).
- **Infrastructure ownership:** Owned GCP/Kubernetes via Terraform and Helm, and built the observability stack that caught bottlenecks before they reached users.
- **Learning from users directly:** Joined customer success calls to understand user issues, then collected metrics and logs in real time to diagnose and fix them.

Key Technologies: React, Node.js, TypeScript, Kafka, PostgreSQL, GCP, BigQuery, Elasticsearch, Terraform, Kubernetes, Helm, CircleCI, GitHub Actions

- Jun. 2023 - **Senior Software Engineer & Tech Lead, Vendoo (YC W22), Remote.**
 Apr. 2024 **Achievements:**
- **Found the cause of low signup rates:** Found that referral campaigns sent users to a signup page with no information about Vendoo. The growth team's A/B test confirmed a custom landing page converted better.
 - **Fixed subscription billing integrity:** Fixed a bug that kept 1% of paying users marked as active after they had cancelled.
 - **Led a team of up to 5 engineers:** Designed, built and shipped backend services end-to-end, owned releases and CI/CD, and aligned technical decisions with product and business goals.
- Jul. 2022 - **Senior Software Engineer, Paerpay (Techstars), Remote.**
 May 2023 Mobile payment integration platform for the restaurant industry.
Achievements:
- **Cut partner support tickets by 30%+:** Built a real-time transaction monitoring pipeline on BigQuery, giving partners instant visibility into payment statuses.
 - **Onboarded national restaurant chains:** Designed adapters for multiple SOAP-based POS systems and REST payment gateways.
 - **Sub-second payments at peak:** Scaled backend services on Firebase and GCP for high-throughput payment processing.
- Sep. 2021 - **Senior Software Engineer & Architect, EMB Software Engineering, Remote.**
 Apr. 2022 Software consultancy delivering cloud-native backends for data-heavy applications.
- **Repeatable client infrastructure:** Owned end-to-end AWS deployment with Terraform, reused across multiple client projects.
 - **Shorter delivery cycles:** Led API-First technical design so teams could build in parallel and integrate with less friction.
- Jan. 2019 - **Senior Software Engineer, Citruslabs (Techstars), Remote.**
 Sep. 2021 Clinical-trial recruitment platform connecting patients to research.
- **Cut customer onboarding from 2 weeks to 1 day (93%):** Redesigned the MySQL data model so new trials were set up through configuration instead of custom development.
 - **Lowered patient recruitment cost:** Built funnel tracking pipelines (1,000+ responses per trial) that exposed a 10% drop-off and drove changes that reduced recruitment cost.
 - **70% faster time-to-market:** Built CI/CD workflows with GitHub Actions on AWS.
- Feb. 2018 - **Lead Software Engineer, Higglers, London.**
 Sep. 2018 Very early-stage SaaS platform for event organizers and traders.
- **Wide ownership at a very early stage:** Led the redesign of the architecture and the engineering team, reported directly to the CEO, and designed and built new features.
- Oct. 2016 - **Software Engineer, cloud.IQ (PayPal), London.**
 Feb. 2018 London startup using AI to help online sellers increase sales.
- **From support to development:** Started in support, learned how clients configure the product, then moved into development and built the proof of concept for the new self-service client portal.
 - **MySQL and MongoDB at scale:** Developed against MySQL tables with millions of rows, plus data research for reports and MongoDB work.
- Feb. 2015 - **Software Engineer, Critical Software, Coimbra.**
 Aug. 2016 Mission-critical car rental system (MobiCS) and a safety engineering management application.
- **Payments and international invoicing:** As MobiCS expanded to Latin America and European countries, refactored the payment and invoicing system for international requirements, and built a custom Java tool on short notice so the client could keep charging users during provider onboarding.
 - **Java EE 6 and 7, PostgreSQL, 24/7 on-call:** Built features in EJB, JPA/Hibernate, JMS and JBoss applications, wrote SQL and PL/SQL, and covered on-call production support.

Education

- 2013 - **MSc in Software Engineering, Coimbra University, Coimbra.**
 Attended
- 2009 - 2014 **BSc in Computer Science, Coimbra University, Coimbra.**

Languages

Portuguese **Native**

English **Professional proficiency**

Used in daily work communication.

Spanish & **Basic proficiency**

French

Able to understand common phrases in professional settings.

Technical skills

Programming Python (Django, FastAPI), JavaScript/Typescript (NodeJS, React), Java, PHP, C

Cloud & Data GCP, AWS, BigQuery, Kafka, Elasticsearch, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform

Databases PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Firestore

CI/CD Github Actions, CircleCI, Jenkins

Social Skills

Communication Bridging the gap between complex backend architecture and business metrics.

Leadership Led and mentored engineering teams, fostering high-scale engineering cultures.

Additional Activities and Interests

IoT problem solver and Arduino enthusiast; home brewing enthusiast.